

Obsidian ERP v4.0 — Architecture Document (Part 1 of 4)

Foundation, Strategic Vision & Core Architecture

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Document Version: 4.0.0
Last Updated: 2026-05-31
Status: APPROVED — Implementation Ready
Supersedes: Pana ERP v3.0 (ARCHITECTURE_V3.md)

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1. Strategic Context

1.1 Why V4?

Obsidian ERP v4.0 is **not** a rewrite. It is a strategic **increment** on the battle-tested V3 architecture with three mandates:

Mandate	Rationale
Full UX Overhaul	V3 pilot in Addis Ababa revealed that premium UI alone doesn't solve usability. V4 shifts from "beautiful forms" to "guided flows" — button-by-button simplicity over form-field mastery.
AI-Native Integration	Natural language interaction layer that lets users complete ERP workflows via conversation. This is not a chatbot — it's an intelligent automation layer that executes real system operations.
End-to-End Completeness	Every module from ERPNext must be present, deployed, and fully usable. No "coming soon" — every workflow from Lead to Cash to GL must function on day one.

1.2 What V3 Taught Us

The V3 pilot with SMEs in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia revealed critical insights:

Observation	V3 Reality	V4 Response
Form Fatigue	Users faced 15+ field forms for simple operations	V4 uses wizard-style flows with auto-populated fields; 3-5 fields max per step
Navigation Confusion	Users couldn't find linked documents	V4 introduces a unified command palette + contextual navigation
Data Entry Errors	Manual entry caused cascading errors	V4 auto-fills from upstream documents; validates in real-time
Training Overhead	Each module needed separate training	V4 AI assistant guides users through any workflow via natural language
Workflow Visibility	Users lost track of where they were in a flow	V4 adds visual flow trackers showing Lead → Quote → Order → Delivery → Invoice → Payment

1.3 The V4 Equation

```
V4 = V3 Architecture (Preserved)
+ UX Revolution (Guided Flows, Wizard CRUD, Auto-Population)
+ AI Layer (Natural Language → System Operations)
+ Module Completeness (All ERPNext DocTypes)
+ Multi-Tenant Deployment (Docker, VPS, Upstream Source of Truth)
+ Brand Rebirth (Obsidian ERP by VersaLabs Studio)
```

2. V3 → V4 Migration Strategy

2.1 What STAYS (V3 Preserved Architecture)

These V3 systems are **production-proven** and will NOT change:

System	File(s)	Why Preserved
Schema-First Types	<code>scripts/generate-types.js</code> , <code>types/doctype-types.ts</code>	Zero type drift — works perfectly
Factory Pattern	<code>lib/api-factory.ts</code> , <code>hooks/generic/</code>	75% boilerplate reduction — proven
DocType Config Registry	<code>lib/doctype-config.ts</code>	Single source of truth — essential
Query Key Factory	<code>lib/query-keys.ts</code>	Cache invalidation — solved problem

System	File(s)	Why Preserved
Frappe Client	<code>lib/frappe-client.ts</code>	Stable SDK wrapper
Zod Schemas	<code>lib/schemas/doctype-schemas.ts</code>	Runtime validation — critical
API Route Structure	<code>app/api/{module}/{doctype}/</code>	RESTful, clean, works
Theme System	<code>lib/theme-context.tsx</code> , OKLCH CSS	Premium dual-theme — keep
Form Components	<code>components/form/</code>	Type-safe form fields — keep

2.2 What CHANGES (V4 Increments)

Area	V3 State	V4 Target	Migration
Page Layouts	Standard list → detail → edit	Wizard flows, guided CRUD, dashboard-first	Rebuild page templates
Navigation	Sidebar-only	Sidebar + Command Palette + Flow Tracker + AI	Add new nav components
CRUD Operations	Manual form fills	Auto-populated wizard steps	New SmartForm engine
AI Layer	Non-existent	Full NL → Action execution	New <code>lib/ai/</code> subsystem
Dashboard	Basic module hubs	KPI-rich, action-oriented home	Rebuild dashboards
Branding	Pana Promotion / VersaForge	Obsidian ERP by VersaLabs Studio	Theme + metadata
Multi-Tenant	Single instance	Docker + tenant isolation	New infra layer
Module Coverage	~60% ERPNext	100% ERPNext equivalent	Add missing modules

2.3 V3 Module Completion Status (Starting Point for V4)

Module	V3 Status	V4 Action Required
Stock: Item	✅ Complete (Golden Template)	UX overhaul only
Stock: Warehouse	✅ Complete	UX overhaul only
Stock: Material Request	🟡 Semi-Complete	Complete + UX overhaul
Stock: Stock Entry	🟡 Semi-Complete	Complete + UX overhaul
Stock: Delivery Note	📄 Docs Only	Full build + UX

Module	V3 Status	V4 Action Required
CRM: Customer	✓ Complete	UX overhaul + Master Module upgrade
CRM: Lead	✓ Complete	UX overhaul + edit propagation
CRM: Contact	✓ Complete (Golden Template 2)	UX overhaul only
CRM: Address	✓ Complete	UX overhaul only
Sales: Quotation	✓ Complete	UX overhaul + attachment support
Sales: Sales Order	✓ Complete	UX overhaul + auto→WO flow
Manufacturing: BOM	✓ Complete	UX + Quality Inspection + Scrap/Loss
Manufacturing: Work Order	✓ Complete	UX + UOM roundup fix
Manufacturing: Workstation	✓ Complete	UX + flow work on Operation link
Manufacturing: Operation	✓ Complete	UX + fixed time option
Buying: Supplier	✓ Complete	UX overhaul only
Buying: Purchase Order	✓ Complete	UX + approval workflow + auto-repeat
Accounting: Sales Invoice	📄 Docs Only	Full build + UX
Accounting: Purchase Invoice	📄 Docs Only	Full build + UX
Accounting: Payment Entry	📄 Docs Only	Full build + UX
Accounting: Journal Entry	📄 Docs Only	Full build + UX
HR: Employee	✓ Complete	UX overhaul only

2.4 NEW Modules for V4 (Not in V3)

Module	DocTypes	Priority
Request for Quotation	RFQ, Supplier Quotation	High
Product Bundle	Product Bundle, Product Bundle Item	High
Item Price Master	Item Price (extended)	High
Quality Inspection	Quality Inspection, QI Template	High
Project (Master)	Project, Task, Timesheet	High
Tax Master	Tax Category, Tax Template	Medium
Terms & Conditions Master	Terms and Conditions (extended)	Medium

Module	DocTypes	Priority
Reseller Utility	Reseller, Commission	Medium
Activity Tracking	Activity Log, Comment	Medium
Item Export	Export Template, Export Log	Low

3. Product Vision & Market Positioning

3.1 Obsidian ERP: The Pitch

"The ERP that runs your business while you run your business."

Obsidian ERP is a **plug-and-play enterprise resource planning system** for Small and Medium Enterprises (SMEs) across any industry. Unlike traditional ERP systems that require months of training and dedicated IT staff, Obsidian ERP is designed so that **a shop floor operator in Addis Ababa or a procurement manager in Nairobi can use it on day one** — with zero training.

3.2 Three Pillars of Obsidian ERP

PILLAR 1: GUIDED SIMPLICITY

Every operation is a guided flow, not a form.
Users click buttons and make choices. The system fills in the rest.
3-step wizards replace 20-field forms.

PILLAR 2: AI-POWERED AUTOMATION

"Create a sales order for Abebe's last quotation"
Natural language commands execute real system operations.
The AI understands context, fills forms, validates data,
and asks for confirmation before executing.

PILLAR 3: COMPLETE & DEPLOYABLE

Every module. Every workflow. Every report.
No half-built features. No "coming soon".
Multi-tenant Docker deployment. VPS-ready.
Upstream source of truth for all client instances.

3.3 Target Market

Segment	Description	Example
Primary	Manufacturing SMEs in East Africa (Ethiopia, Kenya, Uganda)	Printing shops, garment factories, food processors
Secondary	Service-based SMEs needing invoicing + CRM	Consulting firms, agencies, logistics companies
Tertiary	Reseller/White-Label Partners	IT service companies deploying ERP to their own clients

3.4 Competitive Advantage

vs Competitor	Obsidian ERP Advantage
ERPNext (direct)	Dramatically simpler UX, AI-powered, modern React frontend, Ethiopian localization
SAP B1	10x cheaper, cloud-native, no consultant required
Odoo	Faster implementation, no module upselling, guided workflows
QuickBooks	Full manufacturing + inventory (QuickBooks can't do this)
Spreadsheets	Automated workflows, audit trail, multi-user, AI assistant

3.5 Pilot Strategy

Phase	Timeline	Activity
Alpha (Internal)	Month 1-2	VersaLabs team uses Obsidian ERP for internal operations
Beta (3 Clients)	Month 3-4	Deploy to 3 Addis Ababa SMEs via Docker on VPS
GA (Public)	Month 5+	Open onboarding portal, reseller program, SaaS pricing

4. Technology Stack

4.1 Core Stack (Preserved from V3)

Layer	Technology	Version	Purpose
Framework	Next.js	16.x (App Router)	Full-stack React framework
Language	TypeScript	5.9+ (Strict Mode)	Type safety — non-negotiable
Styling	Tailwind CSS	v4.x	Utility-first CSS with OKLCH
State	TanStack Query	v5.x	Server state management
Forms	React Hook Form	v7.x	Performant form handling
Validation	Zod	v3.x	Runtime type validation
Backend	Frappe Framework	v15	REST API provider

Layer	Technology	Version	Purpose
Icons	Lucide React	Latest	Consistent iconography
Animations	Framer Motion	v12.x	Micro-interactions & transitions
Notifications	Sonner	v1.x	Toast notifications
Charts	Recharts	v2.x	Dashboard visualizations

4.2 NEW Dependencies for V4

Package	Purpose	Justification
<code>openai</code> (OpenRouter-compatible)	AI SDK for OpenRouter API	NL → Action execution engine
<code>ai</code> (Vercel AI SDK)	Streaming AI responses, tool calling	Structured AI output with function calls
<code>zustand</code>	Lightweight global state	AI conversation state, wizard state, command palette
<code>@tanstack/react-table</code>	Advanced data tables	List views with inline editing, sorting, grouping
<code>react-joyride</code>	Onboarding tours	First-time user guided walkthroughs
<code>@dnd-kit/core</code>	Drag-and-drop	Kanban boards, workflow builders

4.3 Infrastructure Stack (NEW for V4)

Component	Technology	Purpose
Containerization	Docker + Docker Compose	Multi-service orchestration
Reverse Proxy	Traefik or Nginx	SSL, routing, load balancing
Database	MariaDB (Frappe default)	Per-tenant database isolation
Cache	Redis	Session store, queue, cache
VPS	Any Linux VPS (Hetzner, DigitalOcean, Vultr)	Production hosting
CI/CD	GitHub Actions	Automated build, test, deploy
Monitoring	Uptime Kuma + Grafana	Health checks, metrics

5. Core Architecture (Preserved from V3)

This section is an explicit confirmation that V3's architectural DNA is carried forward unchanged.

5.1 The Six Pillars (Unchanged)

#	Pillar	V4 Status
P1	Schema-First Development	✓ Preserved — <code>generate-types.js</code> continues
P2	Factory Pattern Architecture	✓ Preserved — <code>api-factory.ts</code> + generic hooks
P3	Extreme Modularization	✓ Preserved — domain-first directory structure
P4	Premium UI Standard	✓ Preserved + Enhanced — guided flow UX added
P5	Documentation as Architecture	✓ Preserved — V4 docs replace V3 docs
P6	End-to-End Type Safety	✓ Preserved — TypeScript strict + Zod

5.2 Schema-First Flow (Unchanged)

```

Frappe DocType → generate-types.js → types/doctype-types.ts + lib/schemas/
                                     ↓
                                lib/doctype-config.ts (registry)
                                     ↓
                                lib/query-keys.ts (cache keys)
                                     ↓
                                lib/api-factory.ts (route handlers)
                                     ↓
                                hooks/generic/ (CRUD hooks)
                                     ↓
                                app/{module}/{doctype}/ (pages)

```

5.3 Factory Pattern (Unchanged)

```

// API Routes – SAME AS V3
export const GET = createListHandler("Item", { allowedFields: [...] });
export const POST = createCreateHandler("Item");

// Hooks – SAME AS V3
const { data } = useFrappeList<Item>("Item", { filters: [...] });
const create = useFrappeCreate<Item>("Item");

```

5.4 Directory Structure (Extended for V4)

```

obsidian-erp/
├── app/
│   ├── api/                                # API Routes (V3 – preserved)
│   │   ├── {module}/{doctype}/
│   │   │   ├── route.ts                  # GET list, POST create
│   │   │   └── [name]/route.ts           # GET, PUT, DELETE
│   │   └── ai/                            # NEW: AI API routes
│   │       └── chat/route.ts              # Chat completions

```


└─ execute/route.ts	# Action execution
└─ context/route.ts	# Context resolution
└─ {module}/	# Page Routes (V3 pattern, V4 UX)
└─ {doctype}/	
└─ page.tsx	# List page (V4: enhanced)
└─ new/page.tsx	# Create page (V4: wizard flow)
└─ [name]/	
└─ page.tsx	# Detail page (V4: action-oriented)
└─ edit/page.tsx	# Edit page (V4: wizard flow)
└─ onboarding/	# NEW: Tenant onboarding
└─ page.tsx	
└─ components/	
└─ ui/	# Primitive UI (V3 – preserved)
└─ smart/	# Smart Components (V3 + V4 additions)
└─ form/	# Form Components (V3 – preserved)
└─ Layout/	# Layout Components (V3 + V4 mods)
└─ flows/	# NEW: Guided Flow components
└─ FlowWizard.tsx	# Multi-step wizard engine
└─ FlowTracker.tsx	# Visual workflow progress
└─ FlowStep.tsx	# Individual wizard step
└─ FlowAutoFill.tsx	# Auto-population engine
└─ ai/	# NEW: AI interface components
└─ AICopilot.tsx	# Main AI panel
└─ AIMessage.tsx	# Chat message component
└─ AIActionCard.tsx	# Action confirmation card
└─ AIContextBadge.tsx	# Current context display
└─ command/	# NEW: Command palette
└─ CommandPalette.tsx	# Global search + actions
└─ dashboard/	# NEW: Module dashboards
└─ KPICard.tsx	# Key metric display
└─ ActionCard.tsx	# Quick action button
└─ FlowStatus.tsx	# Workflow status summary
└─ hooks/	
└─ generic/	# Generic Frappe Hooks (V3 – preserved)
└─ useDeleteWithConfirmation.ts	# (V3 – preserved)
└─ useExport.ts	# (V3 – preserved)
└─ useWizardFlow.ts	# NEW: Wizard state management
└─ useAutoFill.ts	# NEW: Auto-population logic
└─ useCommandPalette.ts	# NEW: Command palette state
└─ useAI.ts	# NEW: AI interaction hook
└─ lib/	
└─ doctype-config.ts	# DocType Registry (V3 – preserved)
└─ query-keys.ts	# Query Key Factory (V3 – preserved)
└─ api-factory.ts	# API Route Factories (V3 – preserved)
└─ frappe-client.ts	# Frappe SDK Wrapper (V3 – preserved)
└─ theme-context.tsx	# Theme Provider (V3 – preserved)
└─ utils.ts	# Utilities (V3 – preserved)
└─ schemas/	# Zod Schemas (V3 – preserved)
└─ ai/	# NEW: AI subsystem

```

├── ai-client.ts           # OpenRouter client with fallback
├── ai-tools.ts           # Function definitions for tool calling
├── ai-context.ts         # Context resolution engine
├── ai-executor.ts        # Action execution engine
├── ai-config.ts          # Model configuration + routing
├── flows/               # NEW: Flow engine
│   ├── flow-definitions.ts # Workflow step definitions
│   ├── flow-auto-fill.ts  # Auto-population rules
│   └── flow-validation.ts  # Step-level validation
├── tenant/              # NEW: Multi-tenant utilities
│   ├── tenant-config.ts   # Tenant resolution
│   ├── tenant-middleware.ts # Request-level tenant routing
│   └── tenant-branding.ts # Per-tenant branding
├── types/
│   ├── doctype-types.ts   # Generated Types (V3 – preserved)
│   ├── ai-types.ts        # NEW: AI system types
│   ├── flow-types.ts      # NEW: Flow engine types
│   └── tenant-types.ts    # NEW: Multi-tenant types
├── docs/
│   ├── v3/                # V3 docs (archived, read-only)
│   └── v4/                # V4 docs (this document set)
│       ├── ARCHITECTURE_V4_PART1_FOUNDATION.md # This file
│       ├── ARCHITECTURE_V4_PART2_UX_REVOLUTION.md # UX patterns
│       ├── ARCHITECTURE_V4_PART3_AI_INTEGRATION.md # AI system
│       ├── ARCHITECTURE_V4_PART4_DEPLOYMENT.md # Multi-tenant + ops
│       ├── BUSINESS_WORKFLOW_PART1_LEAD_TO_CASH.md # Business flow
│       ├── BUSINESS_WORKFLOW_PART2_MODULE_SPECS.md # Module specs
│       └── BUSINESS_WORKFLOW_PART3_AUTOMATION.md # Automation rules
├── docker/               # NEW: Docker configuration
│   ├── Dockerfile        # Next.js production build
│   ├── docker-compose.yml # Full stack orchestration
│   ├── docker-compose.dev.yml # Development environment
│   └── nginx.conf         # Reverse proxy config
├── scripts/
│   ├── generate-types.js  # Type Generation (V3 – preserved)
│   ├── setup-tenant.sh    # NEW: Tenant provisioning
│   └── seed-data.js       # NEW: Demo data seeder

```

6. V4 Architectural Increments

6.1 Increment 1: SmartForm Engine (Guided CRUD)

The biggest UX change in V4. Instead of presenting a blank form with 15+ fields, V4 uses a **wizard-based SmartForm** that:

1. **Auto-fills** from upstream documents (e.g., Sales Order auto-fills from Quotation)
2. **Groups fields** into logical steps (3-5 fields max per step)

3. **Validates per step** before advancing
4. **Shows context** — what document this creates, what it links to
5. **Confirms before saving** — preview of what will be created

```
// V4 SmartForm Engine – conceptual API
interface FlowDefinition {
  doctype: string;
  source?: { // Auto-fill source
    doctype: string;
    fetchFields: string[]; // Fields to copy from source
  };
  steps: FlowStep[];
  confirmation: {
    title: string;
    summaryFields: string[]; // Fields to show in preview
  };
}

interface FlowStep {
  id: string;
  title: string;
  description: string;
  fields: FlowField[];
  autoFillRules?: AutoFillRule[]; // Rules to auto-populate
  validationSchema: z.ZodSchema; // Per-step Zod validation
}

interface FlowField {
  name: string;
  label: string;
  type: 'input' | 'select' | 'frappe-select' | 'date' | 'number' | 'switch';
  required: boolean;
  autoFilled?: boolean; // If true, field is read-only (auto-populated)
  helpText?: string;
}
```

6.2 Increment 2: Command Palette

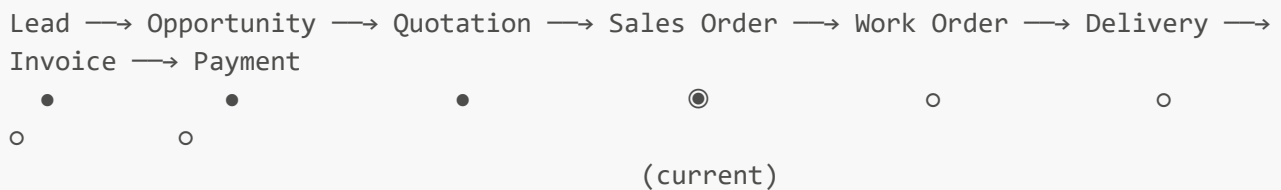
Global keyboard-activated (Cmd/Ctrl+K) search and action palette:

```
interface CommandPaletteAction {
  id: string;
  label: string;
  icon: LucideIcon;
  category: 'navigate' | 'create' | 'search' | 'ai';
  shortcut?: string;
  action: () => void;
}
```

```
// Examples:
// "Go to Sales Orders" → navigates to /sales/sales-order
// "Create new Customer" → opens wizard at /crm/customer/new
// "Find ITEM-001" → searches across all DocTypes
// "Ask AI: What's our best selling item?" → opens AI panel
```

6.3 Increment 3: Flow Tracker

Visual indicator showing the user's position in the Lead → Cash flow:



This component appears on every transactional document page, showing:

- Where the document sits in the business flow
- What came before (clickable links)
- What comes next (action buttons)
- Current status of each stage

6.4 Increment 4: Enhanced DocType Config

V4 extends the centralized config with flow and AI metadata:

```
// V4 Extension to DocTypeConfig
export interface DocTypeConfigV4 extends DocTypeConfig {
  // V4: Flow Engine metadata
  flow?: {
    position: number; // Position in lead-to-cash flow (1-8)
    upstreamDocType?: string; // What feeds into this
    downstreamDocType?: string; // What this creates
    autoFillFrom?: string[]; // DocTypes to auto-fill from
  };

  // V4: AI metadata
  ai?: {
    createVerb: string; // "create", "place", "submit"
    naturalName: string; // "sales order", "quotation"
    searchableFields: string[]; // Fields AI can query by
    actionable: boolean; // Can AI create/modify this?
  };

  // V4: UX metadata
  ux?: {
    wizardSteps?: number; // Number of wizard steps
    dashboardWidget?: 'counter' | 'chart' | 'list' | 'kanban';
  };
}
```

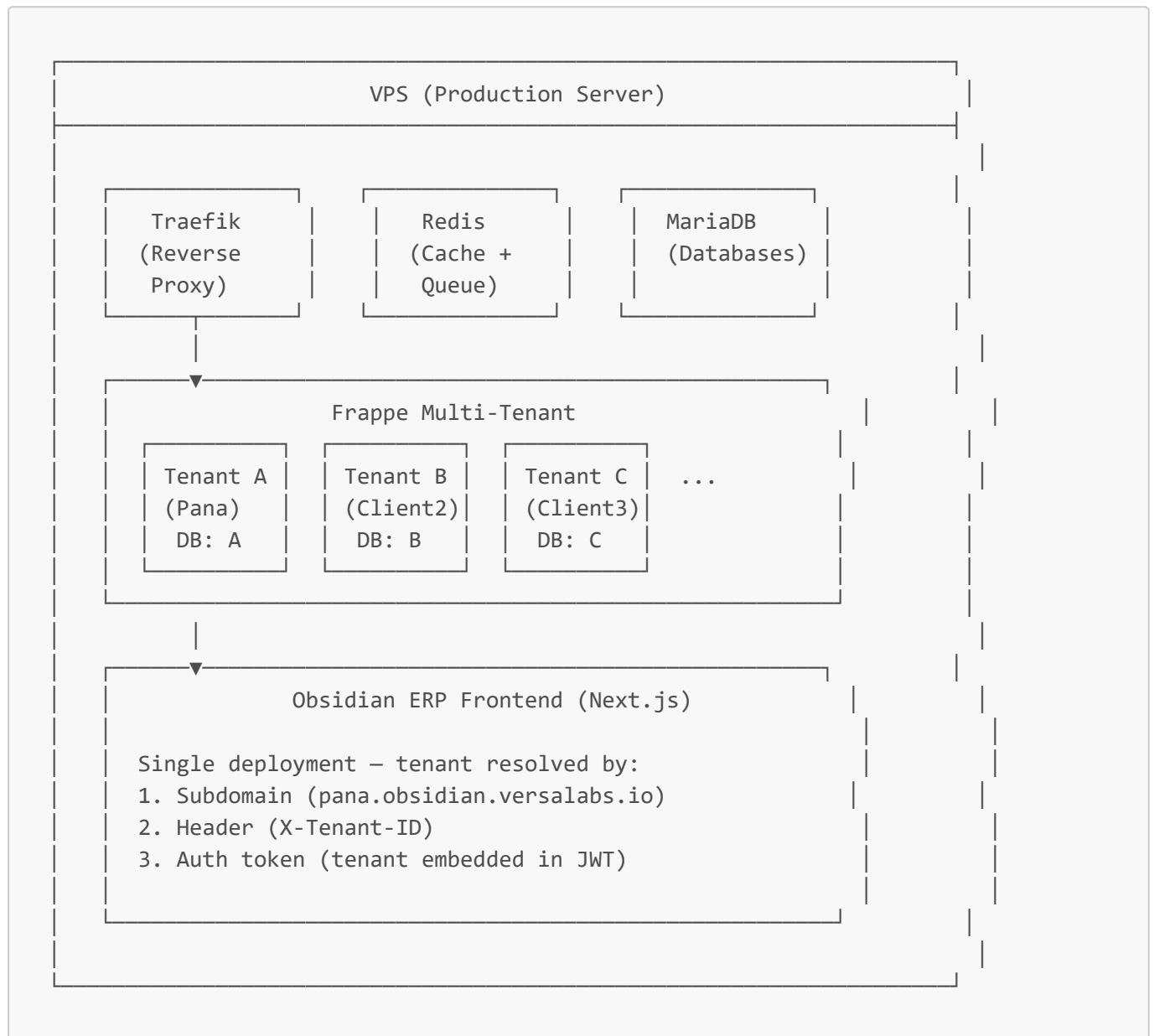
```

requiresApproval?: boolean; // Needs approval workflow?
hasAttachments?: boolean; // Supports file attachments?
};
}

```

7. Multi-Tenant Architecture

7.1 Deployment Model

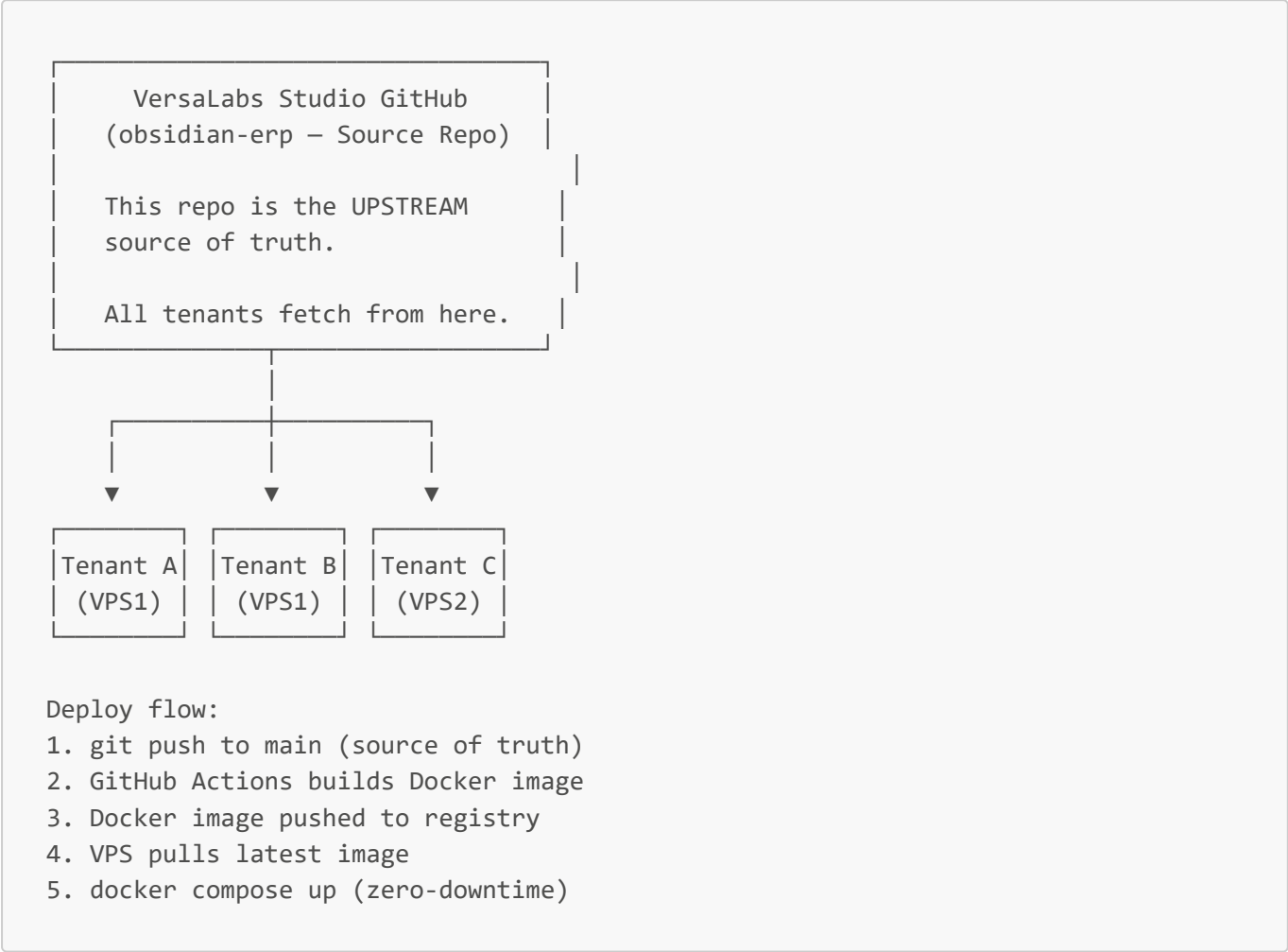


7.2 Tenant Isolation Strategy

Layer	Isolation	Implementation
Database	Full isolation (separate DB per tenant)	Frappe multi-tenancy (bench)
Frontend	Shared code, tenant-resolved config	Middleware resolves tenant from subdomain
API	Routed to correct Frappe site	X-Frappe-Site-Name header

Layer	Isolation	Implementation
Branding	Per-tenant logo, colors, company name	<code>tenant-branding.ts</code> config
Storage	Isolated file storage per tenant	Frappe <code>sites/{site}/</code> structure

7.3 Source of Truth Architecture



8. Brand Identity: Obsidian ERP

8.1 Brand Assets

Asset	Old (V3)	New (V4)
Product Name	Pana Promotion ERP / VersaForge ERP	Obsidian ERP
Company	—	VersaLabs Studio
Logo	Pana logo	New logo (provided by Kidus)
Tagline	—	"The ERP that runs your business while you run your business."
Domain	—	<code>obsidian.versalabs.io</code> (proposed)

8.2 Theme Tokens (V4 Rebrand)

The OKLCH color system is preserved but rebranded:

Token	Purpose	Light Mode	Dark Mode
<code>--color-obsidian-brand</code>	Primary brand color	<code>oklch(0.35 0.02 260)</code>	<code>oklch(0.55 0.18 265)</code>
<code>--color-obsidian-accent</code>	Accent/CTA color	<code>oklch(0.65 0.20 165)</code>	<code>oklch(0.70 0.20 165)</code>
<code>--color-background</code>	Page background	<code>oklch(0.98 0.005 260)</code>	<code>oklch(0.13 0.015 260)</code>
<code>--color-card</code>	Card surfaces	<code>oklch(1 0 0)</code>	<code>oklch(0.17 0.015 260)</code>
<code>--color-foreground</code>	Primary text	<code>oklch(0.15 0.02 260)</code>	<code>oklch(0.95 0.005 260)</code>

8.3 Code-Level Brand Changes

```
// app/layout.tsx - V4 metadata
export const metadata: Metadata = {
  title: "Obsidian ERP",
  description: "Enterprise Resource Planning by VersaLabs Studio – Guided Simplicity for SMEs",
};

// localStorage key migration
const THEME_KEY = 'obsidian-erp-theme'; // was: 'pana-erp-theme'
```

Summary

Part 1 establishes:

- 1.  **Strategic context** — why V4, what V3 taught us
- 2.  **Migration strategy** — what stays, what changes, module status
- 3.  **Product vision** — Obsidian ERP positioning, market, pilot plan
- 4.  **Technology stack** — V3 preserved + V4 additions
- 5.  **Core architecture** — Six Pillars confirmed, schema-first preserved
- 6.  **Architectural increments** — SmartForm, Command Palette, Flow Tracker
- 7.  **Multi-tenant design** — Docker, VPS, source of truth model
- 8.  **Brand identity** — Obsidian ERP by VersaLabs Studio

Next: Part 2 covers the full UX Revolution — page templates, wizard flows, dashboard design, and the new Golden Template for V4.

